

Job Market Website and Online Presence

Advice from Michael Ewens (Columbia Business School)

Agenda

- Caveats and assumptions
- Goals
- Online parts
 - Website
 - Social media
 - Linkedin
 - Caltech site

Caveats and Assumptions

Job candidate != professor

- My own website – and those of other faculty – does not follow the guidelines that follow
- Why?
 - Different audiences and goals
- → whatever you build for this year should change after you get that first job

My assumptions

- What follows assumes that you are looking first for a TT research position
- Does **not** imply this is the only nor best post-PhD option
- Instead, what I know best and tends to match goals of the typical PhD student
- Fortunately, industry, think-tank, gov't and related jobs all profess to want to hire people who **could** join academia
 - → build something for the academic market

Website presence Goals

I thought the job market paper was all that mattered?!

Goals

- People are busy (+lazy), so make it easy for them
- Put on your recruiting hat....what are they trying to do?
 - A: Find your information and papers
- Communicate your area and where you fit
- Download everything in one click (low friction)
- Top result for Google

People are busy (and lazy)

- Last year, hiring committee had relatively targeted search and > 450 applications
- Five committee members and interview invites 6 weeks after deadline
→ not enough time to read every packet in great detail
- **Website** = condensed, easy-to-use version of your job market
“packet”

What do recruiters want?

- An application has 6-7 files: research statement, CV, JMP(s), letters of recommendation, personal statement, diversity statement...
- Who knows what the hiring committee member uses in screening stages (not race, gender, ethnicity, age, etc!)
- → your website provides paths to all materials and answers to high-level questions
 - E.g. Research area, basic bio, etc.

Who is this person as a researcher?

- Hiring can be “any field”, but is often narrowed down to fields
- Separation between theory vs. empirical critical in many positions
- → short bio or list of keywords that quickly show what kind of research you do and will do in the future

Single click to information

Amazon Found Every 100ms of Latency Cost them 1% in Sales

10 years ago, Amazon found that every 100ms of latency cost them 1% in sales. Google found an extra .5 seconds in search page generation time [dropped traffic by 20%](#). A broker could lose [\\$4 million in revenues per millisecond](#) if their electronic trading platform is 5 milliseconds behind the competition.

The expectations of today's NOW customers continue to grow and the amount of data generated and accessed is mind boggling. Bernard Marr, in his article in [Forbes](#) describes the last two years

What Causes Friction on Your Ecommerce Site?

Personal

Friction occurs when a customer's flow is disrupted, and something distracts or discourages them from making a purchase.

Interview request

Simply put, friction is anything that gets in the way of conversions.

getting interviews.

Examples

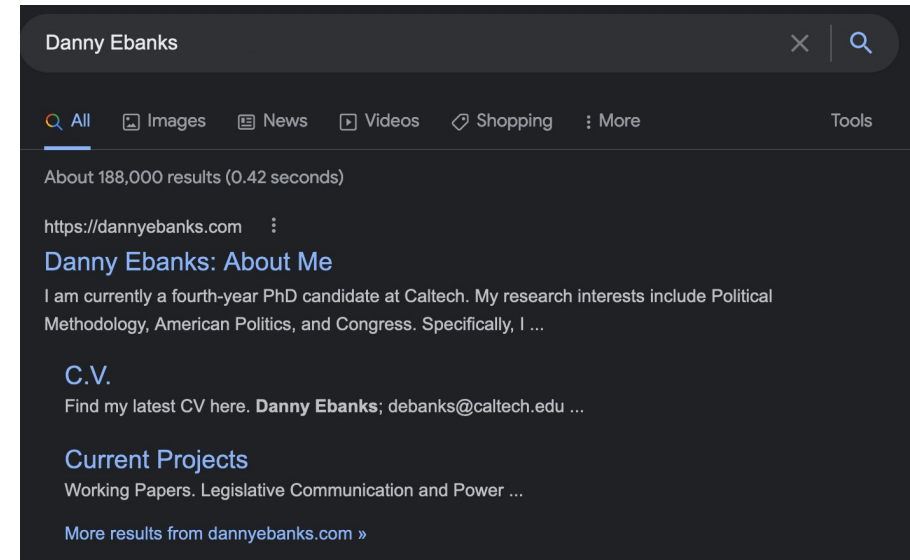
“I just want to download X!”

- CV link on every page (i.e., have a page header)
 - It is ok to have a page with a link to the pdf
- Research page on page header
- Self-hosted pdf to your JMP (more later)

Google as the gateway

Setting: recruiting meeting and someone wants to look up your paper

- Goal 1: you are the first search result for your name
- Goal 2 (reach): give google your site structure



Steps to please Google

- Informative page title
 - Your name and affiliation
- Google sitemap
 - Or just make sure you have clear site structure
- Domain name = your name
- Links to your website
 - From institution, SSRN, LinkedIn, Twitter

Home > [Search Central](#) > Documentation

Was this helpful?  

Build and submit a sitemap

[Send feedback](#)

This page describes how to build a sitemap and make it available to Google. [Learn more about sitemaps here.](#)

1. Decide which [sitemap format](#) you want to use.
2. [Create the sitemap](#), either automatically or manually.
3. [Make your sitemap available to Google](#) by adding it to your robots.txt file or directly submitting it to Search Console.

Quality of content

After identifying relevant content, our systems aim to prioritize those that seem most helpful. To do this, they identify signals that can help determine which content demonstrates expertise, authoritativeness, and trustworthiness.

For example, [one of several factors we use to help determine this is understanding if other prominent websites link or refer to the content.](#) This has often proven to be a good sign that the information is well trusted. Aggregated feedback from our

Online presence components

The online package

The parts

- Your website
- Your institution site
- Google Scholar
- SoArvix | SSRN paper (post something)
- Social
 - Twitter (I know)
 - LinkedIn
- Github
- Google yourself forthings

Personal website

- You need one for the market (the AEA says so)
- You will need one in the future
- Buy yourname.com (\$10-15/year)
 - Google likes this
 - Don't buy on the service that hosts your site (e.g., Google sites)
 - Use namecheap.com or similar
 - Longer term: another version of yourname.com

Design?

- For the job market site, remember
 - Recruiters are busy / lazy
 - People online have trouble following through to get to things
- → clean, simple design
- E.g. no scroll on home page
- If you have a friend who does web design, then feel free to spruce it up
 - BUT, anything that distracts from CVs, JMP links and “who is this person” risks lowering “conversion”

Required content

- Home page
 - Links to everything below
 - Probably just make this your research listing
- Header with links to main content on every page
- CV page + pdf
- Research
- Teaching
- Footer: name, affiliation, email address
- About page (longer version of home page summary)
- Maybe
 - Search (if you have that much content)
 - Links to other sites like Github
 - Google analytics (over-rated and you can become obsessed)

Places to host your site

Create a site that you can take with you, so:

- Wordpress.com
- Google sites (with some limits on pdfs below)
- Your own server (web hosting)
- Github Pages
- Squarespace / Wix
 - Don't recommend (up-selling and branding)

Don't: host pdfs on google/dropbox

- We want high conversion rates → minimize clicks

Host on google drive without a direct to download

Host on dropbox without a direct to download

Add ?dl=1 to the end of the link

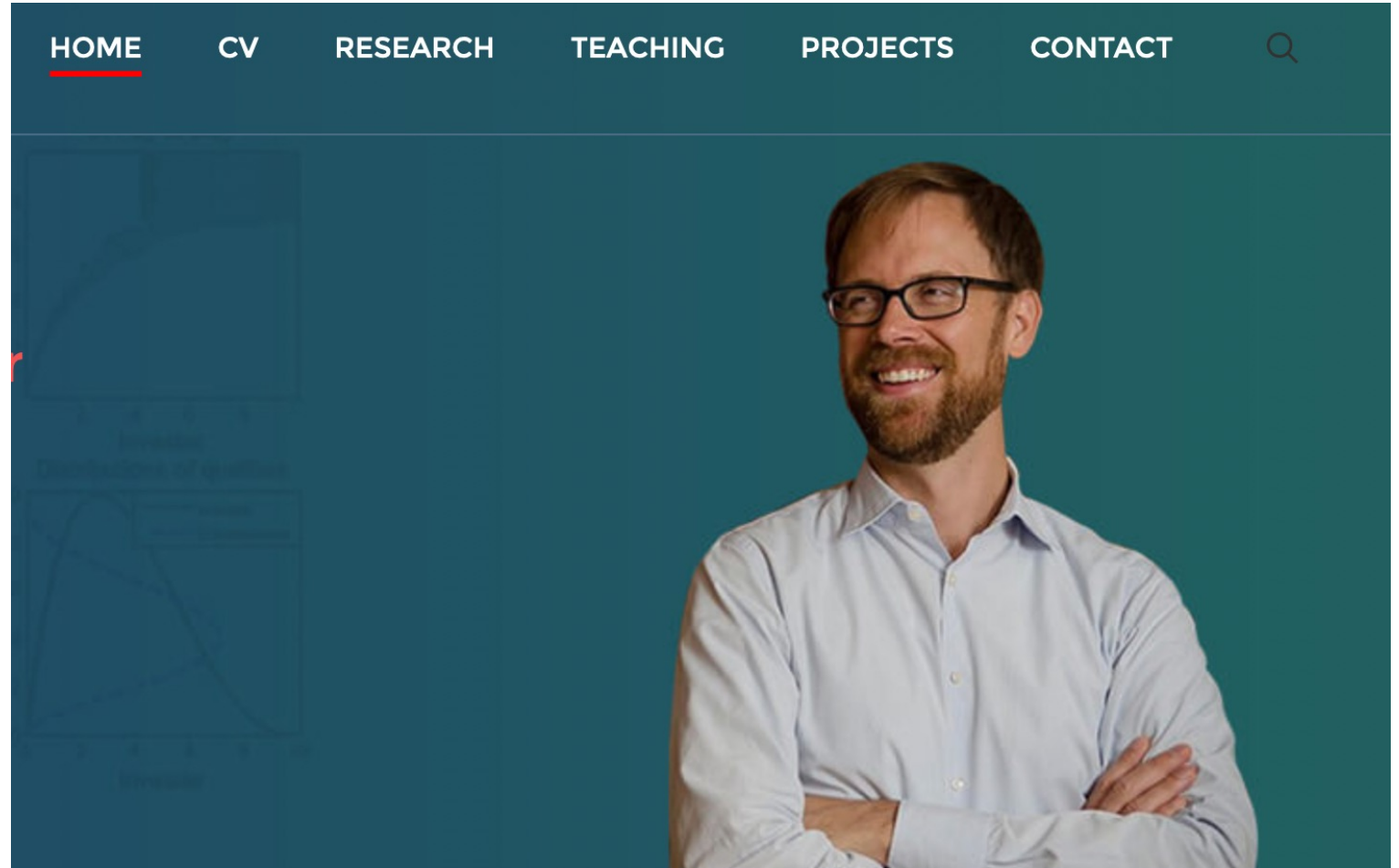
Embed a pdf in html: risky that it won't work

Do: host “directly”

- Your university likely gives you a simple server for hosting files
- If you use a webhost like Wordpress, they will provide file space for media

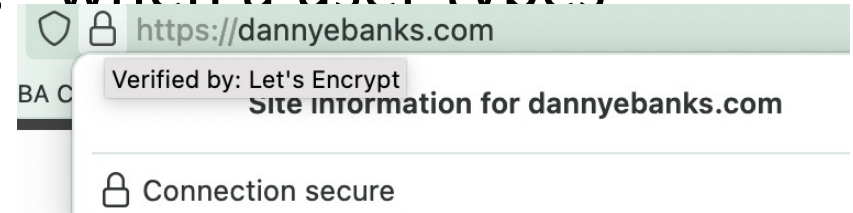
Do: add a picture to your site

Pro-tip: avoid the aspirational and reminiscent photo used here



Don't: link to http only

- Many modern browsers default to “https:” when a user types yourname.com
- If you don't have that configured, browser freaks out
 - Thinks you are spam or selling a crypto scheme
- Almost all website providers will provide a way to use the secure site https:
 - Message me if you are having issues



Do: link to coauthors on the research page

- People want to know who you are working with

Publications

[1] “**Young Firms, Old Capital**” (with [Justin Murfin](#) and [Ryan Pratt](#))
Journal of Financial Economics, Forthcoming, 2022
[Online Appendix](#)]

[2] “**Bankrupt Innovative Firms**” (with [Joy Tianjiao Tong](#) and [Wei Wang](#))
Management Science, Forthcoming, 2022
[\[Online Appendix\]](#)

- Can have the link open in a new page to minimize frictions

Do: mention you are a candidate

- Put “above the fold”
 - I am on the X job market during the 2022-23 academic year.”

Do: test on another computer

When creating your site, you may only see it in

- 1 browser
 - 1 operating system
 - 1 (great) internet connection
 - You are logged in as an admin
-
- → Ask a family member to view from another location

Maybes / nice to have

- Short slide deck associated with your paper
 - People don't read papers 😞
- Research page with *abstracts* + 1 picture/table
 - Make it even easier to understand you
- Is there uncertainty about your name's pronunciation?
- Teaching page
 - If you have the experience; depends on your target market

Paper hosting: your site and portal

- Your site's server
- SocArxiv
- Arxiv
- SSRN
 - Google Scholar searches
 - People are used to it
- Make sure versions are up to date across platforms
 - Add link in pdf to known “permanent” location



Institution website

- Your PhD institution should provide a “person” page with your headshot and contact info
- Populate it with as much as you can
 - Google often goes here first
- Make sure you link to your personal site
 - Google-friendly
- Ensure that pdf links to CV and papers are “live” not old docs

Google Scholar

- **Goal:** you pop up on google scholar searches + your name is underlined



Nadya Malenko

Associate Professor of Finance, [University of Michigan](#), Ross School of Business
Verified email at umich.edu - [Homepage](#)

[Corporate Finance](#) [Corporate Governance](#) [Private Equity](#) [Organizational Economics](#)
[Information Economics](#)



- You need at least one pdf for google to populate
 - But you can add your own
- Don't worry about cites

The screenshot shows the 'Add new work' form in Google Scholar. At the top, there are tabs for different document types: Journal, Conference, Chapter, Book, Thesis, Patent, Court case, and Other. Below these are input fields for Title, Authors (with an example: Patterson, David; Lamport, Leslie), Publication date (with an example: 2008, 2008/12 or 2008/12/31), Journal, Volume, Issue, Pages, and Publisher. A blue checkmark icon is visible in the top right corner of the form area.

Social

- Twitter! Really?
 - Recruiting committees have young TT faculty
 - Some faculty on Twitter highlight/spotlight candidates → make it easy for them
 - You don't have to tweet or like anything (might want to avoid during market)
 - But...tweet your JMP (paper thread)
- Get your name while you can!

Get featured or tagged...



Jennifer Doleac @jenniferdoleac · Oct 29, 2018

Author: Smriti Bhargava, econ job market **candidate** at Clemson.
smritib.com



Justin Sandefur @JustinSandefur · Oct 29, 2018

"Why Did Indian Female Labor Force Participation Decline?"
wixlabs-pdf-dev.appspot.com/assets/libs/pd... ht @jenniferdoleac

Answer: Rising wages. Even though women's earnings rose faster, effect of husbands' earnings dominated. Cross-wage > own-wage elasticity.

LFP of wives:
2004: 35%
2011: 24%

Abstract

1. Indian married women's labor force participation (LFP) declined from 35% in 2004 to 24% in 2011, even while the economy grew, educational attainment rose, and the labor supply revealed positive wives' own-wage elasticity. To study this decline in LFP, I use India's National Family Health Survey (NFHS) sample of matched husband-wife pairs. The results suggest that the explanation may lie in rising wages. Even though women's earnings rose faster, the effect of husbands' earnings dominated. Cross-wage > own-wage elasticity. Estimating the model for the period 1983-2011, I find a 1 percentage point increase in women's LFP of 8.6 percentage points, a decrease of 20.8 percentage points, and a decrease of 20.8 percentage points.

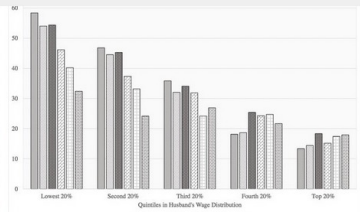


Table 6: Estimation of Wives' Labor Force Participation, Using Two-stage Least Squares

Dependent Variable: LFP	1983	1987	1993	2004	2007	2011	Pooled
Wife's Own Wage	0.174*** (0.0053)	0.052*** (0.0048)	0.122*** (0.0051)	0.121*** (0.0050)	0.126*** (0.0058)	0.127*** (0.0061)	0.117*** (0.0066)
Husband's Wage	-0.107*** (0.0039)	-0.107*** (0.0048)	-0.107*** (0.0047)	-0.107*** (0.0046)	-0.108*** (0.0045)	-0.108*** (0.0045)	-0.107*** (0.0045)
Elasticity at Mean:							
Wife's Own Wage Elasticity	0.254*** (0.0100)	0.202*** (0.0106)	0.222*** (0.0104)	0.201*** (0.0112)	0.201*** (0.0112)	0.199*** (0.0112)	0.199*** (0.0112)
Husband's Wage Elasticity	-0.208*** (0.0125)	-0.208*** (0.0129)	-0.208*** (0.0140)	-0.208*** (0.0140)	-0.208*** (0.0140)	-0.208*** (0.0140)	-0.208*** (0.0140)
Cragg Donald Wald F statistic	7016.89	13184.84	5228.92	7886.83	6799.91	4836.17	4175.57
Mean Values							
LFP of Wife	35.0	35.7	31.8	31.1	30.0	27.2	31.5
Wife's Own Wage	3.7	3.9	4.1	4.2	4.4	4.5	4.3
Husband's Wage	4.6	5.0	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	5.0
Observations	94384	102608	96673	104729	110133	17261	97965

Notes: Wages refer to first values of log real daily imputed wage. Two-tailed significance are carried out during the bootstrap. Each year's regression estimates are used to estimate the cross-sectional elasticity. Sample means are reported in parentheses. Standard errors are in parentheses. * denotes significance at 10 percent, ** denotes significance at 5 percent, *** denotes significance at 1 percent.



Rick Hornbeck

785 Tweets



Rick Hornbeck

@Rick_Hornbeck

Economist, Economic Historian. Soccer Dad.

[Translate bio](#)

voices.uchicago.edu/richardhornbeck... Joined June 2020

295 Following 3,270 Followers

Example paper thread

Twitter thread about your paper:

- Give people something to retweet
- Might start a conversation
- Opportunity to tag people
- Figure out how to summarize paper in 5-9 tweets
- (you will have to plan it in a Word doc)

 about paper with [@kairong_xiao](#) + [@TingXuFinance](#). We explore public firms' regulatory avoidance: manipulating public float. TLDR: firms bunch around regulatory thresholds  reveal major \$ of being public. Though meaningful, costs cannot explain  listed firms 1/

Regulatory Costs of Being Public: Evidence from Bunching

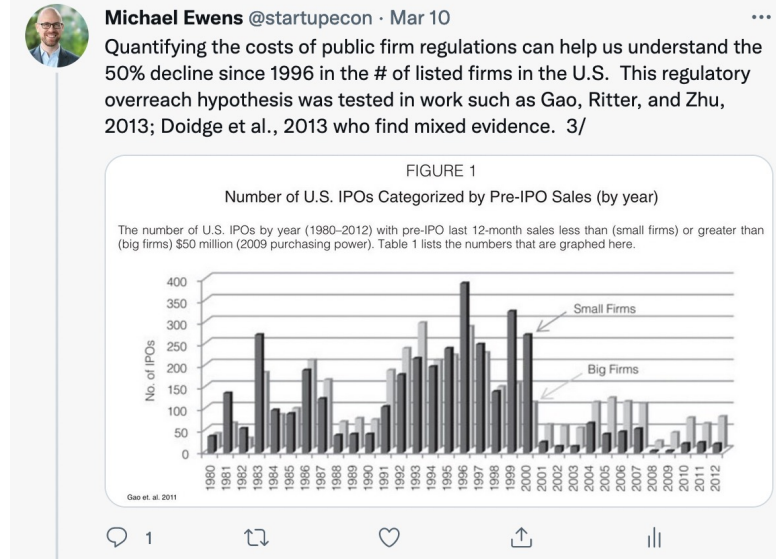
Estimation *

Michael Ewens[†] Kairong Xiao[‡] Ting Xu[§]

January 31, 2022

Abstract

We quantify the regulatory costs of being public by exploiting a regulatory quirk: many rules trigger when a firm's public float exceeds a threshold. Consistent with firms seeking to avoid costly regulation, we document significant bunching around multiple regulatory thresholds. A bunching estimation shows that various disclosure and internal governance rules lead to a total compliance cost of 4.1% of the median firm's market capitalization. Regulatory costs have a greater impact on private firms' IPO decisions than on public firms' going private decisions, but such costs only explain a small part of the decline in the number of public firms.



Michael Ewens @startupecon · Mar 10

Many imp. public firm disclosure+governance regulations are threshold-based: firms  certain level of public float (approx. market cap) do not need to comply. Our regulatory cost estimation takes advantage of firms' bunching below thresholds (i.e., revealed preference)4/

Bunching estimation: model



<https://twitter.com/startupecon/status/1501983945604272148>

Twitter tips



- Use tags #EconTwitter and equivalent for your field
- Find and follow people in your field after you get your profile set up
 - See who follows whom
- If you have something to say, reply!
 - Not just “I agree” or “Here is a paper (mine) that is relevant”

LinkedIn



Michael Ewens



- Older folks primarily use this as their social network
- Create a profile with all the trimmings
 - Picture, CV, link to your website, etc.
 - Google likes LinkedIn
- Probably wait on connecting to potential employers

Other sites



- If you have code or data to share, then great opportunity to signal transparency
- If you are proud of your code, then good place to advertise skills
- SSRN profile page
 - Fill it in (some people use this as their main site)

Google yourself

- Some of those search results can be “cleaned” or “removed” if you don’t like it

Examples to emulate I

Emanuele Colonnelli



Curriculum Vitae

Contact Information

Emanuele.Colonnelli@chicagobooth.edu

Education

PhD in Economics, 2018

Stanford University

Affiliations

National Bureau of Economic Research
(NBER), Faculty Research Fellow (CF, DEV)

Center for Economic Policy Research
(CEPR), Research Affiliate (DE, FE)

Bureau for Research and Economic
Analysis of Development (BREAD), Affiliate

Mailing Address

The University of Chicago Booth School of
Business, 5807 S Woodlawn Ave, Chicago,
IL 60637, USA

Academic Appointments

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business

2022— Associate Professor of Finance and MV Advisors Faculty Fellow

2018—2022 Assistant Professor of Finance, Liew Family Junior Faculty Fellow, and Fama Faculty Fellow

Working Papers

Selfish Corporations (with Niels Gormsen and Tim McQuade) [Revise and Resubmit at the *Review of Economic Studies*]

[+] Abstract

[Control Video] [T-Economy Video] [T-Bad Video] [T-Good Video]

Investing with the Government: A Field Experiment in China (with Bo Li and Ernest Liu)

[+] Abstract

Politics at Work (with Valdemar Pinho Neto and Edoardo Teso)

[+] Abstract

[Online Appendix] [Supplementary Material]

Life After Death: A Field Experiment with Small Businesses on Information Frictions, Stigma, and Bankruptcy

(with Shai Bernstein, Mitch Hoffman, and Benjamin Iverson)

[+] Abstract

[Control Video] [Information Video] [Information+Stigma Video]

Publications

Revealing Corruption: Firm and Worker Level Evidence from Brazil (with Spyridon Lagaras, Jacopo Ponticelli, Mounu Prem and Margarita Tsoutsoura) [*Journal of Financial Economics*, 143, No. 3, March 2022: 1097-1119]

[+] Abstract

Examples to emulate II



Yale SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT



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[Curriculum Vitae](#)
[Google Scholar](#)

Research Interests

Primary: Innovation, Entrepreneurial Finance, Corporate Finance, Big Data

Secondary: Behavioral Finance, Education, Law and Economics, Antitrust

Publications

[1] “**Young Firms, Old Capital**” (with [Justin Murfin](#) and [Ryan Pratt](#))
Journal of Financial Economics, Forthcoming, 2022
[Online Appendix](#)

[2] “**Bankrupt Innovative Firms**” (with [Joy Tianjiao Tong](#) and [Wei Wang](#))
Management Science. Forthcoming. 2022

Working Papers

[10] “**The Education-Innovation Gap**” (with [Barbara Biasi](#))
NBER WP w29853, 2022
[\[Online Appendix\]](#) [\[VOX\]](#)

[11] “**Innovation Networks and R&D Allocation**” (with [Ernest Liu](#))
NBER WP w29607, 2022
[\[Online Appendix\]](#)

[12] “**Payout Taxation and Corporate Investment: The Agency Channel**”
Resting Paper, 2020

Teaching

- “Entrepreneurial Finance”, *Yale SOM Elective*
- “Venture Capital and Private Equity”, *Yale SOM Elective*
- I was recognized as “**40 Under 40 Best Business School Professors**” by Poets and Quants in 2021

Useful Links

- [WEFI: Workshop on Entrepreneurial Finance and Innovation](#)
 - A bi-weekly, virtual workshop featuring research in entrepreneurial finance and innovation
 - Co-organizers: [Michael Ewens](#), [Yael Hochberg](#), and [David Robinson](#)
- WEFI Lecture: Interactions Between Startups and Incumbents [\[Video\]](#) [\[Lecture Webpage\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#)
 - *Overview:* This is a talk presented as part of the WEFI lecture series that intends to summarize emerging areas of the literature on entrepreneurial finance and innovation. The topic of “Interactions Between Startups and Incumbents” connects a large part of my work at the intersection of corporate and entrepreneurial finance.

Next steps

1. Get your domain or equivalent asap
2. Decide on a host or provider (email me with issues)
3. Post any circulating WP on SSRN or *arxiv
4. Set up your Google Scholar page with picture
5. Social media accounts
 - Helps to have your website working